

Career Forge Day – 6 Report

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COLLEGE: VIDYALANKAR POLYTECHNIC

DAY: 6

GIT BRANCH: Day-6

Commander Decision Brief

LaunchRoom report file/link: [../Day-6 LaunchRoom Report.pdf](#)

1. Top Priority

What did you protect first?

I protected payment and order integrity first, with customer trust as the guiding principle. During the incident, duplicate charges, failed payments, and order inconsistencies directly impacted customers' money and confidence in the platform. To address this, I prioritized webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression, customer communication, and payment containment measures.

Why?

Because customer-money issues were identified as the most critical risk in the incident. Duplicate charges and payment-success-without-order-confirmation could cause financial harm, damage trust, increase support load, and create long-term reputational consequences. Protecting customers and ensuring transaction correctness was more important than preserving short-term revenue or analytics visibility.

2. Second Priority

What mattered next?

The second priority was customer communication and support containment. After stabilizing payment and order issues, I focused on publishing FAQ guidance, refund instructions, and transparent customer updates to reduce confusion and support pressure.

Why did it come second?

After protecting payments and orders, I prioritized customer communication and support containment. Transparent updates and FAQ guidance reduced confusion, support pressure, and reputational risk while the technical fixes were being implemented.

3. Intentional Deferral

What did you intentionally not solve during the pressure window?

I intentionally deferred analytics, dashboard visibility, and non-critical reporting work. Instead of spending resources on improving visibility tools, I focused on payment processing, order integrity, and customer-facing systems.

Why was deferring it acceptable?

I intentionally deferred analytics and dashboard visibility improvements because they were not contributing to the customer-facing failure. During the incident, protecting payments, orders, and customer trust was more important than improving reporting or visibility tools.

4. Accepted Risk

What risk did you knowingly accept?

I knowingly accepted the risk of temporary revenue impact, increased refund requests, delayed analytics visibility, and some remaining inventory reconciliation work while prioritizing payment integrity and customer trust. I also accepted short-term public scrutiny by communicating transparently before the root cause was fully confirmed.

Why was that risk better than the alternative?

I accepted short-term revenue loss, higher refund volume, and delayed analytics visibility because protecting customer money and trust was more important than optimizing business metrics during the incident.

5. Stakeholder Communication

Who needed communication first?

The first stakeholders requiring communication were affected customers and the support team. Customers needed clarity about payments, refunds, and order status, while support agents needed consistent guidance to handle the surge in tickets effectively.

What would you tell them?

We are currently experiencing issues affecting some orders and payments during the FlashCart launch. Affected customers may see delayed order confirmations, duplicate charges, or incorrect order status updates.

Our engineering team is actively working on containment and resolution. If you have been affected by a duplicate charge, we are reviewing cases and will ensure eligible refunds are processed. We will continue providing updates as new information becomes available.

We understand the frustration this has caused and appreciate your patience. Our highest priority is protecting customer payments and ensuring order accuracy.

6. Next 30-Minute Plan

List the next three actions after the simulation window.

1. Complete customer and payment reconciliation
2. Monitor and validate the hotfix
3. Conduct incident review and remediation planning

7. One Decision I Would Change

Which decision would you change?

I would change the first decision (T+02), where checkout remained live because the prompt timed out.

What would you do differently?

Instead of allowing the default outcome, I would have immediately evaluated a controlled containment strategy, such as rate limiting, queueing traffic, or temporarily restricting affected checkout paths while engineering investigated payment inconsistencies.

What did you learn?

I learned that early containment decisions have a disproportionate impact on incident outcomes. The report specifically identified a timeout and reactive containment as risk signals. Faster action at the start could have reduced duplicate charges, support volume, and customer frustration.

8. Final Command Rationale

My incident command approach focused on protecting customers, maintaining transaction integrity, and reducing long-term business risk. I prioritized payment and order correctness over short-term revenue and analytics visibility because customer-money issues were the highest-severity threat. Engineering efforts were directed toward containment and root-cause mitigation, while communication efforts reduced confusion and support pressure. I intentionally accepted temporary revenue impact, refund volume increases, and delayed reporting to prevent greater customer harm. Throughout the incident, I balanced technical containment, stakeholder communication, and operational continuity under time pressure. This approach contained the incident while preserving customer trust and business stability.